PRACTICAL COURSE WORKBOOK

n8n Self-Hosted Automation

Design a reliable workflow that reduces repetitive work

LEVEL	Intermediate
GUIDED TIME	5 hours across 12 lessons
PROJECT	a mapped automation with tests and recovery steps
SKILLS	n8n, Self-hosted, AI nodes, Critical evaluation, Documentation
EDITORIAL STATUS	Structured draft v0.9

WHAT YOU WILL BE ABLE TO DO

- Use n8n appropriately in a realistic, bounded task.
- Use Self-hosted appropriately in a realistic, bounded task.
- Use AI nodes appropriately in a realistic, bounded task.

WHO THIS IS FOR

People designing reliable no-code and low-code workflows.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- Basic spreadsheet and web-app experience

COURSE MAP

From foundation to finished work

n8n Self-Hosted Automation is a structured, practical course covering n8n, Self-hosted, AI nodes. It emphasizes explainable methods, checked work and a final outcome that can be reviewed.

MODULE	LESSONS AND FOCUS
01 n8n: Workflow design	1. Triggers with n8n 2. Actions with Self-hosted 3. Data mapping with AI nodes
02 Self-hosted: Building	1. Connections with n8n 2. Conditions with Self-hosted 3. Transformations with AI nodes
03 AI nodes: Reliability	1. Errors with n8n 2. Testing with Self-hosted 3. Monitoring with AI nodes
04 n8n: Operations	1. Documentation with n8n 2. Security with Self-hosted 3. Maintenance with AI nodes

HOW TO STUDY EACH LESSON

1. Read the objective and identify the decision it supports.
2. Reproduce the worked example with the stated input.
3. Test one normal case and one boundary or failure case.
4. Complete the knowledge check without guessing.
5. Save a short evidence note: result, limitation and next action.

CAPSTONE PROJECT

Produce a reviewable n8n Self-Hosted Automation project using n8n, Self-hosted, AI nodes.

DELIVERABLE	A working n8n Self-Hosted Automation artefact plus an evidence-based self-review.
TOOLS	A suitable n8n environment, A plain-text decision log, Test data or realistic sample material

Production plan

1. Define the intended user, outcome and constraints.
2. Create the smallest complete result using n8n.
3. Test one normal case, one boundary case and one failure response.
4. Revise the work from the evidence and preserve before-and-after results.
5. Prepare a concise handover containing method, limitations and next step.

Definition of done

- The output matches the stated outcome.
- Inputs and decisions are reproducible.
- Boundary and failure evidence is included.
- Limitations and responsibility considerations are explicit.

Evidence log

INPUT	Original brief, data, requirements or test material.
DECISIONS	Chosen method and one reasonable alternative.
TESTS	Normal, boundary and failure results.
LIMITATION	What the result does not establish.
REVISION	One evidence-led improvement.

REVIEW AND SOURCES

Make the work credible and repeatable

Final self-review

- Can another learner repeat the method?
- Did I test a difficult case?
- Did I avoid unsupported claims?
- Is the next action proportionate to the remaining risk?

Authoritative references

API Security Top 10

OWASP Foundation - reviewed 2026-08-21
https://owasp.org/API-Security/

HTTP Semantics

IETF - reviewed 2026-08-21
https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc9110

SOURCE NOTE

Product versions, laws and professional standards can change. Recheck the linked primary source before applying version-sensitive information.

NEXT IMPROVEMENT

Choose one weakness found during review and improve it before extending the n8n scope.